PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Superficial Chemical Peel

The manufacturer's directions for your peel always come first. Times are typical.

CONSULT
Intake, Fitzpatrick type and skin analysis done. Consent signed. Product and strength within your state's scope.

PATCH TEST
Behind the ear or along the jaw a few days before the first peel. Check at 24–48 hours.

PRIME 2–4 WEEKS
Daily SPF 30+. For Fitzpatrick IV–VI or pigment, add a brightener such as azelaic or kojic acid.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Neutralizer & cool water ☐ Saline eyewash ☐ Eye pads ☐ Petrolatum ☐ Fan & timer ☐ Gauze or fan brush

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Review & inspect**	3–5 min	Confirm health changes. Look under magnification. Stop for an active cold sore, open lesions or sunburn.
2	**Cleanse**	2 min	Cover hair. Gentle, non-exfoliating cleanser. Rinse and pat dry.
3	**Degrease**	1–2 min	Prep solution or 70% isopropyl until skin looks matte. Even prep gives even penetration.
4	**Protect**	1 min	Petrolatum on eye corners, nostril creases, lip corners and lip line. Eye pads on.
5	**Apply**	Per label	Forehead, cheeks, nose, around the mouth and chin, then feather the jawline. Note the time of each layer.
6	**Monitor**	Throughout	Never leave the client. Ask for sensation 0–10. Fan for comfort, but not with salicylic acid.
7	**Watch the endpoint**	—	AHAs: stop at even redness; any white or gray means neutralize now. Salicylic: a white crystal film that wipes off is normal. Superficial peels: no frost, or pinpoint Level I at most.
8	**Neutralize or remove**	1–2 min	AHAs (glycolic, lactic, mandelic): neutralizer until fizzing and itching stop, then cool water. Salicylic and Jessner's self-limit: rinse with cool water.
9	**Cool**	3–5 min	Cool compresses.
10	**Calm & protect**	2 min	Soothing or occlusive product, then mineral SPF (zinc oxide or titanium dioxide).
11	**Educate & rebook**	3 min	Walk through the aftercare handout. Book the next peel 2–4 weeks out.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Too hot or frosting: neutralize or rinse right away, then cool.
- In the eye: flush with saline; same-day physician visit.
- Hives or swelling: remove product. Call 911 if breathing is affected.
- Blisters, oozing or pustules later: refer to a physician.
- Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24–48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS PEEL

Product · lot	Strength % · pH	Layers · time each	Total contact time
Endpoint · redness 0–3 · frost	**Neutralizer · when**	**Client sensation 0–10**	**Reaction · initials**